The office-building spree has not been without controversy. In the western state of Rajasthan, where the BJP was then in power, the state's urban development and housing (UDH) department sanctioned land for BJP offices in twenty-eight of the state's thirty-three districts in 2017. Department officials told journalists that the land was to be allotted on district lease committee (DLC) rates of the area, with no concession to the ruling party. The state minister for UDH who sanctioned it, the BJP's Srichand Kriplani, told the *Deccan Herald*, 'In 28 districts land will be allotted for BJP offices. We have almost finalised land in all the districts except two. Rajasthan will lead in the land allotment to BJP.' The minister claimed that the decision was taken in public interest and that 'any party can approach government and seek land for the construction of their office'.

The decision, however, was heavily criticised by the Congress, then in Opposition in the state. 'This is illegal and BJP is in power, which is why it is allocating land for its own offices,' Archana Sharma, a Congress spokesperson, told the newspaper.[75]

Why the BJP Is Building Libraries, State Unit Archives and New Party Histories

If the new district party offices are the physical manifestation of the BJP's organisational vigour, its drive to create libraries and research documentation centres in each of its state unit offices is envisaged as the lifeblood, meant to create an ideological bonding among its cadres. It is important to understand the vital importance of these party libraries and how the BJP's strategists view them.

The process started in December 2016 with the creation of the Nanaji Deshmukh Memorial Library at the BJP office in Raipur, Chhattisgarh. Personally inaugurated by the then party president Amit Shah, and supported by the then BJP state government,[76] this new library was created as a repository of a rare collection of around '10,000 books and documents ranging from BJP ideology' to works of the 'founding fathers of RSS, BJP & RSS'.[77] The BJP sees history as a primary tool of ideological mobilisation for its cadres and ideas.